

POST INDEPENDENCE DEVELOPMENTS

WINDS OF CHANGE

MODULE-20



1. ENVIRONMENTAL MOVEMENT

ISSUE

In 1973 in Uttarakhand, villagers were protesting against practices of commercial logging by a sports manufacturer of the forest department.

OBJECTIVE

Addressing economic issues of landless forest workers and guarantees of minimum wages.

DEMAND

- Villagers demanded that no forest-exploiting contracts should be given to outsiders.
- Local communities should have effective control over natural resources like land, water and forests.
- Demanded government to provide low cost materials to small industries and ensure sustainable development.



CHIPKO MOVEMENT

METHOD

They had a novel tactic of protest- hugging the trees to prevent them from being cut. It got international attention

FEATURES

- 1 Larger issues of ecological and economic exploitation were raised.
- 2 Active participation of women.
- 3 Agitated against habit of alcoholism encouraged by forest contractors.
- 4 Movement expanded to cover other social issues as well.

ACHIEVEMENT

Government issued a ban on felling of trees in the Himalayan region for fifteen years until restoration of green cover.



2. ENVIRONMENTAL MOVEMENT

1

Multi-purpose projects comprising thousand big and small dams were constructed on the Narmada valley in the states of Madhya Pradesh, Gujrat and Maharashtra.

2

Sardar Sarovar Project is a multi-purpose dam on Narmada- expected to benefit Gujrat and neighboring states in terms of availability of drinking water and water for irrigation, generation of electricity and increase of agricultural production; and effective flood and drought control.



ISSUE

- Hundreds of villages were expected to get submerged. Hence relocation and rehabilitation of the affected.
- NBA opposed these developmental projects and argued with the government on question of public interest.

DEMAND

NARMADA BACHAO ANDOLAN

- They demanded consideration to be given to a loss of livelihood and culture of people and depletion of ecological resources.
- They demanded local communities to be involved in the decision making process and have control over the natural resources.
- Mobilised opinion at the international level and used Satyagraha to gather public opinion

ACHIEVEMENT

- National Rehabilitation Policy was formed by the government in 2003
- Became a precedent to be followed by movements

CRITICS OF MOVEMENT

- process of development hindered
- Access to water and economic development will be denied if project is stalled
- SC- approved construction of dam with proper rehabilitation



3. ECONOMIC MOVEMENTS

Focus group- Indian fishers located in the eastern and western coastal areas of India

ISSUE

- Lives of these fishermen threatened by government permission to mechanized trawlers and technologies like bottom trawling for large-scale harvest of fish in the Indian seas.
- Local fish workers' organizations argued with State governments over issues of livelihood as fisheries is a State subject



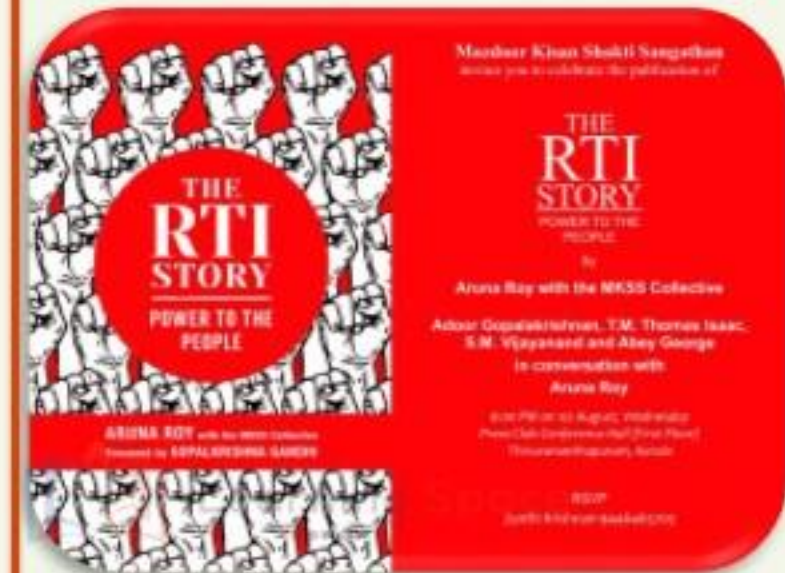
NATIONAL FISH WORKERS FORUM

- 1** Economic liberalization encouraged these organizations to organize on a national level called National Fishworkers' Forum or NFF.
- 2** Fish workers' from Kerala were in the forefront of mobilizing the workers'.
- 3** Government had launched deep sea fishing policy and opening up of India's waters to large commercial vessels.
- 4** NFF worked for those having fishing as their livelihood. It collaborated with world organisations to protect ecology and livelihood of fishermen.



4. POLITICAL MOVEMENTS

- 1** In 1990, mass based organization, Mazdoor Kisan Shakti Sangathan (MKSS) in Rajasthan demanded records of famine relief work, copies of bills and accounts of labourers who have been paid wages for construction of schools, dispensaries, small dams and community centres.
- 2** In the Rajasthan Panchayat Act – an amendment was permitted in the Rajasthan Panchayat Raj Act to permit public to procure documents held by Panchayats. Panchayats budgets were to be published on board or newspapers
- 3** In 1966, MKSS formed National Council for People's Right to Information in Delhi to turn RTI into a national campaign.
- 4** The Shourie Committee proposed a draft RTI. Finally in June 2005, RTI Bill was passed



POST INDEPENDENCE DEVELOPMENTS

FUNCTIONING OF DEMOCRATIC POLITICS

1 Movements are coming together of people with similar issues, and expectations

2 Movements mobilized by poor, socially and economically disadvantaged groups- voices of social groups need to be incorporated

3 Movements to raise issues and rectify problems

4 New social groups whose economic and social grievances not addressed

5 Representation of diverse groups and demands incorporated

6 Democracy expanded- people made aware of their rights in a democracy- educative task eg RTI

CRITICS

- Functioning of government disrupted
- Decision making delayed
- Destabilise routine functioning of democracy



5. DALIT MOVEMENTS

BACKGROUND

Dalits had experienced brutal caste injustice. They were dishonoured and deprived access to public places.

1 Legal mechanisms were inadequate. Political parties like Republican party of India were not successful in electoral politics.

2 Dr Ambedkar envisioned socio-economic change for the Dalits outside the Hindu-caste structure.

3 In 1970s, students from the Dalit communities started graduating. These Dalit youths organized a militant organization called the Dalit Panthers in 1972.



DALIT MOVEMENTS

OBJECTIVE

- Mass action for Assertion of Dalit rights.
- Fight against caste-based inequalities and material injustice faced by Dalits

DEMAND

Effective implementation of reservation, abolition of untouchability and similar policies of social justice.

IDEOLOGICAL AGENDA

Destroy the caste system, build an organization of all oppressed sections

RESULT

- Platform for Dalit educated youth to use creatively protest for their rights
- Dalit writers protested in their literary works- especially Marathi literature which made it more broad and representative
- Participated in electoral politics.
- Growth of organisations like Backward and Minorities Communities Employees Federation (BAMCEF)



6. LABOUR MOVEMENTS

- 1 January 1988- twenty thousand farmers gathered in Meerut
- 2 Objective- Protest against government decision to increase electricity rates
- 3 Action taken-Disciplined agitation of camping against district collector's office where food was supplied by nearby villages
- 4 Feature- Show of rural power of farmer cultivators
- 5 Farmers were members of Bhartiya Kisan Union- an organization of farmers from Uttar Pradesh and Haryana. It began as a pressure group



BHARTIYA KISAN UNION

These farmers benefited from the Green revolution- Sugar and wheat became the cash crops of these areas.

With the advent of Liberalisation, the BKU demanded :

1 Higher government floor pricing for sugarcane and wheat.

2 Abolition of restriction on inter-state farm produce.

3 Guaranteed supply of electricity at reasonable rates.

4 Waving off repayments due on loans.

5 Government pension for farmers.



BHARTIYA KISAN UNION

ACHIEVEMENTS

Got some economic demands accepted. They grew cash crops for the market. But confined to only the prosperous states.

ACTIVITIES ORGANIZED

Demonstrations, rallies, jail-bharo (courting imprisonment)
Used caste linkages of farmers. The caste panchayats of these communities discussed economic issues.

OTHER ORGANIZATIONS

Shetkari Sanghatana - Maharashtra- farmer movement symbolizing the rural agrarian Bharat against the forces of India, which comprised the urban industrial sector. Re-started the debate between Agriculture and Industry.



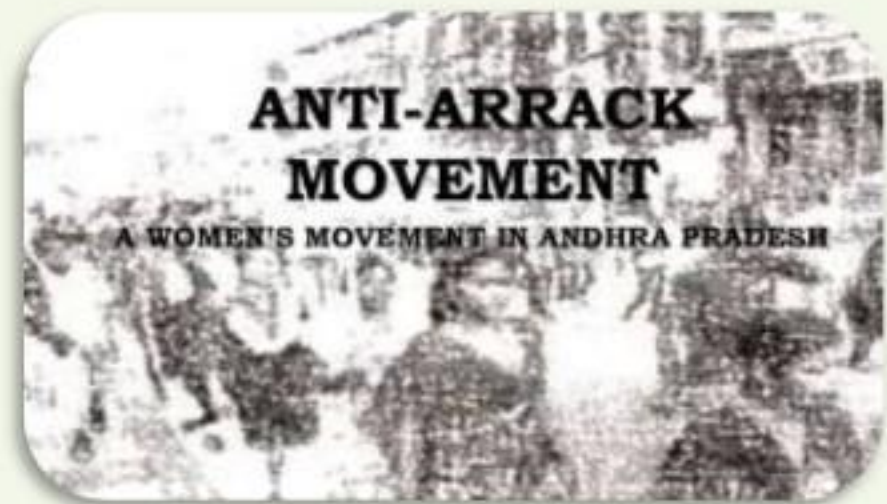
7. ANTI-ARRACK MOVEMENT

REASON

- Alcoholism had penetrated deep into the village people and was affecting their physical and mental health.
- It affected the rural economy- men spent on alcohol and did not go to work.
- Women were the worst sufferers as they had to bear the violence from the male members.

ACTION TAKEN

- Women in Nellore took spontaneous initiatives and forced closure of wine shops.
- Similar to BKU, in Andhra Pradesh, women mobilized demanding a ban on the sale of alcohol in their neighbourhoods.



ANTI-ARRACK MOVEMENT

- 1 Rural women from villages fought against mafias and government. Crime and arrack developed a close nexus.
- 2 As the news spread, women gathered and passed resolution to impose prohibition. This came to be known as Anti-Arrack movement.
- 3 It touched larger social, political and economic issues of women. They discussed openly about domestic violence.
- 4 These campaigns eventually led to constitutional representation of women in politics through the 73rd and 74 CAA granting reservations to women in local level.



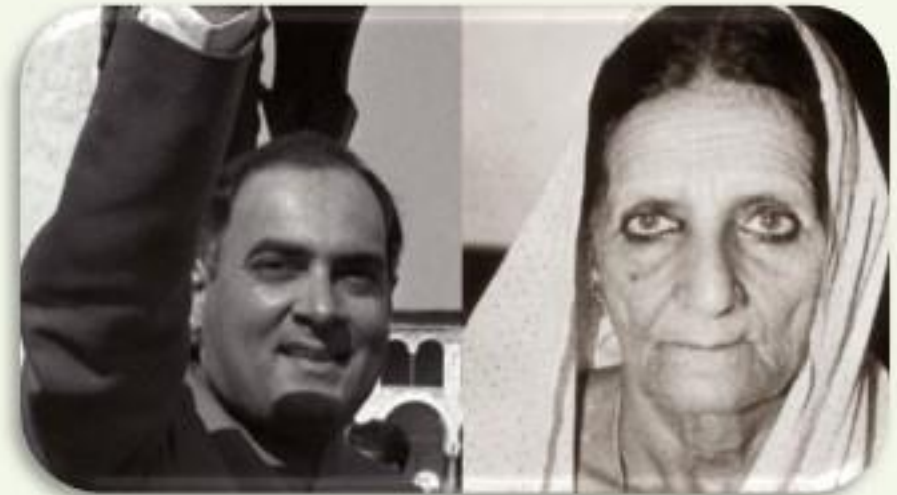
8. SHAH BANO CASE

1

The petitioner was an elderly man named Mohammed Ahmed Khan, who wished to appeal against a lower court's decision demanding that he pay monthly maintenance to his divorced wife, Shah Bano.

2

In rejecting Khan's appeal, the Supreme Court invoked Section 125 of the Criminal Procedure Code, whereby a divorced woman was entitled to claim an allowance from her ex-husband if he had taken another wife, and if she had not remarried and could not otherwise maintain herself.



SHAH BANO CASE

1 On 23 April 1985, the Supreme Court confirmed that Khan would have to continue to pay Shah Bano maintenance as fixed by the High Court. The judges linked it to the question of Uniform Civil Code.

2 A common civil code would help the cause of national integration by removing disparate loyalties to laws which have conflicting ideologies.

3 Muslim clerics criticized the judgement as an attack on Islam. In 1985–86, Rajiv Gandhi already had the support of 400 MPs.

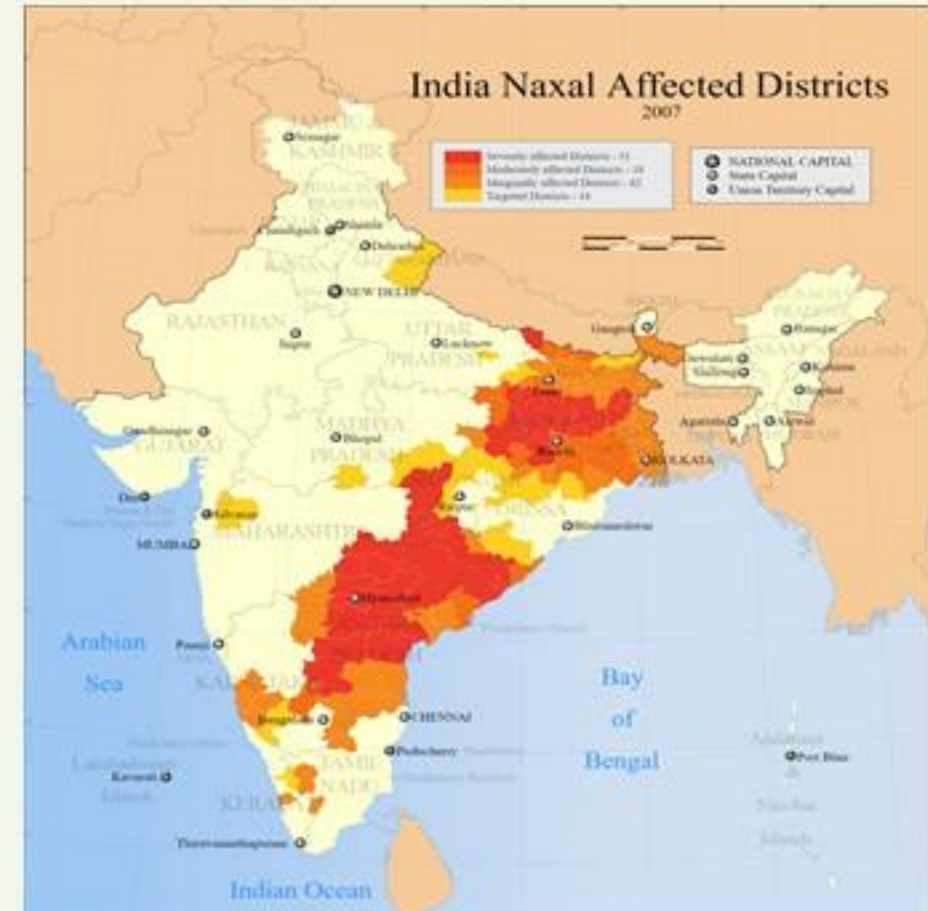


9. NAXALITE MOVEMENT

1 The Naxalites were also active among the Scheduled Tribes (or adivasis), the other group recognized by the Indian Constitution as historically disadvantaged.

2 The adivasis lived in the most resource-rich areas of India – with the best forests, the most valuable minerals, and the free-flowing rivers.

3 Over the years they had lost many of these resources to the state or to outsiders, and struggled hard to retain what remained.



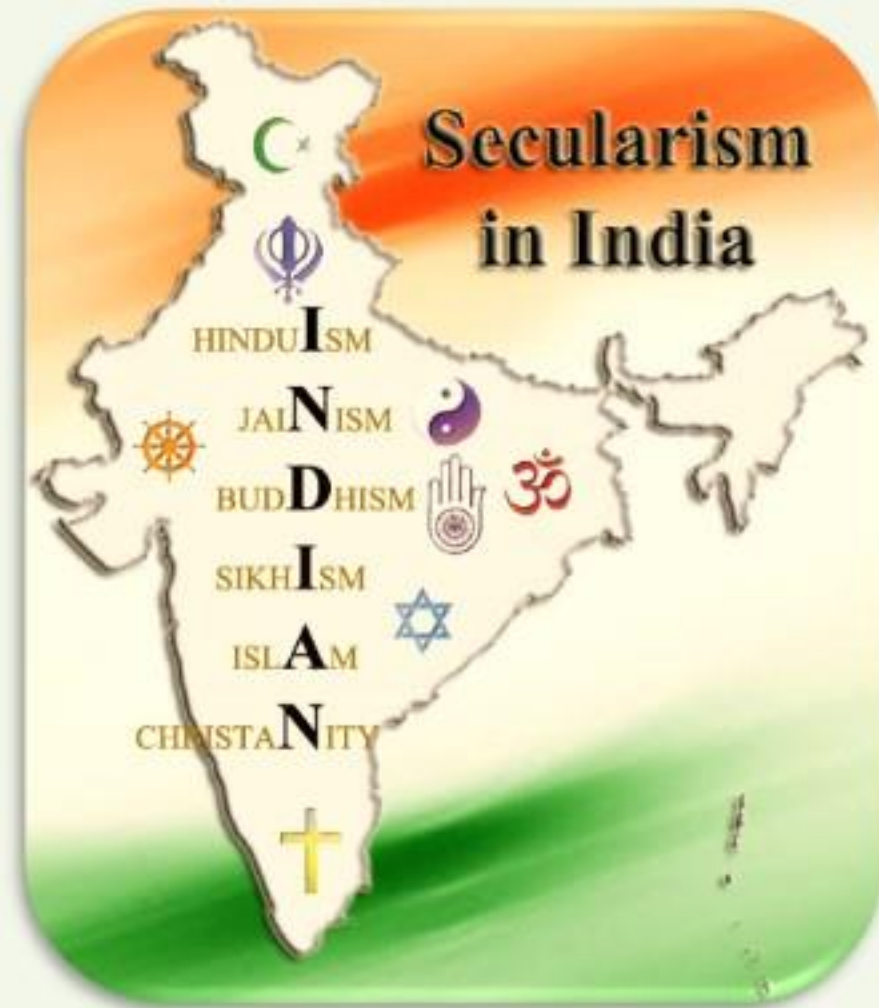
NAXALITE MOVEMENT

- 1 1967- Naxalbari police station in Darjeeling district of West Bengal, peasant uprising took place. It eventually spread to other states and came to be referred to as the Naxalite Movement.
- 2 The movement was used to snatch land from the rich landowners and gave it to the poor and landless.
- 3 Forced labour encroachment of resources by outsiders and exploitation by moneylenders
- 4 They used violent measures to achieve their goals. Government has in, turn taken strong measures.
- 5 Most of the areas affected by the movement are inhabited by Adivasis. – the cultivators are denied their basic rights
- 6 Charu Majumdar was the leader of the Naxalbari uprising. He participated in the Tebhaga movement. He founded the Communist Party of India (Marxist-Leninist)



10. RELIGIOUS MOVEMENTS

- 1 Secularism was, indeed, an idea that underlay the very foundations of free India.
- 2 Gandhi insisted that the multiple faiths of India can and must co-exist peaceably in a free nation. This was a belief shared by Gandhi's most prominent follower, Nehru.
- 3 Partition brought fresh challenges to Secularism.
- 4 In colonial times, the whole of India had come under a common penal code, drafted in the 1830s.

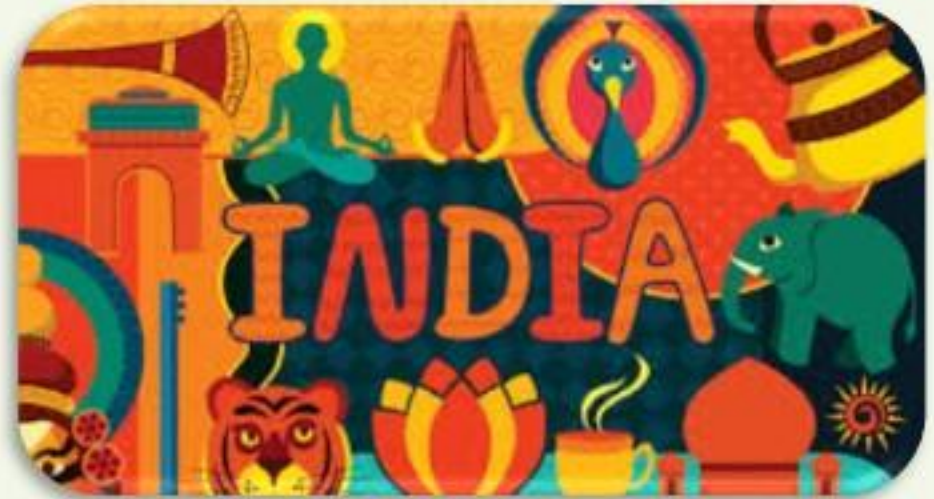


RELIGIOUS MOVEMENTS

1 After Independence, among those favoring a common civil code were the prime minister, Jawaharlal Nehru, and the law minister, Dr B. R. Ambedkar.

2 Both were of a modernist cast of mind.

3 Article 44 of the Constitution of India reads: 'The State shall endeavour to secure for the citizens a uniform civil code throughout the territory of India.'



1 During the last years of their rule the British had belatedly initiated the framing of a uniform code for Hindus.

2 A committee had been setup in 1941 chaired by Sir B. N. Rau, who was also to play a crucial role in drafting the Indian Constitution.

3 The 'Hindu' Code Bill was to apply to Sikhs, Buddhists and Jains as well as all Hindu castes and sects. Introducing the new bill, Ambedkar told the Assembly that its aim was to 'codify the rules of Hindu Law which are scattered in innumerable decisions of the High Courts and of the Privy Council.



Hindu Code Bill Comm

and on Dharma Shastras'.

Anti-Hindu-code-Bill Committee supported by conservative lawyers

or to inherit property



11. OTHER SOCIAL MOVEMENTS

1 Discussions on social and economic issues gave rise to independent social movements like anti-caste movement, Kisan Sabha and trade union.

2 In 1970s and 1980s, many sections of the society- Students, Dalits, Adivasis

- disillusioned with functioning of political parties
- failure of the Janata government
- Political instability- lost faith in democratic institutions
- Poverty and inequality persisted- injustice and deprivation
- Social inequalities like caste and gender remained

3 They stepped out of party politics and engaged in mass mobilisations.



TRADE UNIONISM



OTHER SOCIAL MOVEMENTS

1 Urban middle class women organized to protests against issues affecting women – custom of dowry, sexual abuse at work and public places, sexual violence against women.

2 Peasants in Telangana organized massive agitations – focused on issues of economic injustice and economic inequality under the leadership of Communist parties and demanded redistribution of land to cultivators.

3 Peasants and agricultural labourers of Andhra Pradesh, West Bengal, Bihar and adjoining areas- continued agitations under the Marxist-Leninist workers became pressure groups within parties.



ASSESSMENT

- 1** Peasants launched struggles in defence of their forest rights, tribals protested against their displacement by large industrial projects and artisanal fisherfolk opposed trawlers that were depleting the fish stocks of the ocean.
- 2** In these protests two things stood out: the leading role of women, who themselves bore the brunt of ecological degradation, and the fact that, unlike in the West, where the concern for nature was couched in aesthetic terms and voiced by the middle class, this was an 'environmentalism of the poor', driven by rural communities for whom access to the gifts of nature was linked to their very survival.
- 3** These movements were described as 'new' because they took up issues neglected by the old, class-based social movements of peasants and workers.



ASSESSMENT

1 The violation of civil liberties and human rights during Emergency encouraged Kapil Bhattacharya to form an Association for the Protection of Democratic Rights.

2 The trade union movement, which had historically focused on the factory sector, now began working among miners and laborers in household and cottage industries.

3 Among the more notable initiatives was the Chhattisgarh mineworkers Shramik Sangh (CMSS), whose leader Shankar Guha Niyogi sought to blend the ideas of Gandhi and Marx was a into a new kind of Indian press

4 'India's Newspaper Revolution' which began in 1977 and has gathered pace ever since.

5 The spread of education and the expansion of the middle class gave an enormous fillip to Indian-language journalism.



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